

LEGISLATIVE UPDATE



GA HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES SCOTT HILTON HOUSE DISTRICT 48

Dear Friends & Neighbors,

My top priority is serving you as your State Representative.

On April 4, the Georgia General Assembly adjourned Sine Die after 40 days of session. I'm proud to share this newsletter highlighting the common-sense wins that will help keep Georgia the best state to live, work, and raise a family.

This session brought exciting news for our district: House Speaker Jon Burns appointed me Chairman of the Information & Audits Committee, giving our community an even stronger voice at the Capitol. I was also named to the influential Ways & Means Committee, which oversees Georgia's tax policy.

While I'm honored by these new responsibilities, my top priority remains serving you. Our office can help with a wide range of needs—from arranging a Capitol tour or recognizing an individual or group with an official Resolution, to navigating issues within state government.

You are always welcome to reach out to me personally. I treasure hearing your ideas and insights as we work together to keep our community strong.

Scott Hilton

Priorities This Legislative Session



SAFEGUARDING OUR SCHOOLS

As the father of three school aged children, I am passionate about ensuring Georgia students have access to a safe learning environment. Following the tragedy at Apalachee High School, I joined House leadership in meeting with superintendents, teachers, parents, and students across the state to identify ways to improve school safety.

The result was H.B. 268—a comprehensive reform package that includes behavioral health coordinators, threat assessment teams, and faster transfer of student records. Backed by over \$100,000 in safety grants per school, this measure builds on existing progress and reinforces our ongoing commitment to safe, secure classrooms.

DELIVERING ON LAWSUIT REFORM

This year, Governor Kemp called on the General Assembly to take decisive action to address skyrocketing insurance premiums through meaningful lawsuit reform.

The legislature responded by passing S.B. 68 and S.B. 69—bills that protect consumers and restore balance to our civil justice system. These reforms preserve victims' rights while eliminating incentives for frivolous lawsuits and reducing the "tort tax" every Georgian pays when our courts are misused. I was honored to stand alongside our business community and hard-working Georgians to champion these smart, commonsense solutions.

CELL PHONE FREE CLASSROOMS

With cell phone use among students at an all-time high, it's more important than ever to protect the integrity of our classrooms. **That's why I was proud to author House Bill 340 – the Distraction-Free Education Act, which prohibits personal cell phone use in grades K-8.**

Schools that have gone cell phone-free are already seeing the benefits: improved grades, fewer distractions, and stronger student mental health. H.B. 340 is a commonsense step toward keeping our classrooms

focused—where teachers can teach, and Georgia's brightest young minds can thrive.

PROTECTING ACCESS TO IVF

I believe every woman and family should have the right to access IVF treatment. That's why I co-sponsored H.B. 428—to officially protect IVF access in Georgia law.

For countless families facing infertility, the miracle of IVF has made the dream of parenthood possible. I will always stand with and fight for these families.

RESPONDING TO LOCAL ISSUES

This session, I co-sponsored legislation to address fiscal mismanagement by the Gwinnett County School Board, supported a new senior tax exemption for Fulton County, and helped rename the GA-400 and Holcomb Bridge interchange in honor of fallen Roswell Police Officer Jeremy Labonte.

Significant Legislation Passed This Session

HB 111 | Income Tax Reduction - Cut income taxes by additional \$800M, lowering the state income tax another twenty basis points

SB 79 | Cracking Down On Narcotics - Establishes tougher criminal penalties for manufacturing or trafficking the deadly fentanyl drug

HB 129 | Strengthening Our Workforce - Enhances Georgia's workforce by aligning educational programs with high-demand careers - helping students find jobs sooner

SB 148 | Investing In Our Teachers - Increases the number of teachers sick/personal days 3 to 5 per year

SB 1 | Riley Gaines Act - Keeps biological males out of girls' sports

HB 423 | Emergency Response Times - Enables the use of phone calls, texts, and multimedia messages by first responders

HB 196 | Lowering Drug Costs - Supports independent pharmacies, ensuring they are not reimbursed below actual cost

SB 185 | Protecting Taxpayers - Bans taxpayer funding for sex change operations for convicted felons in Georgia prisons

HB 266 | Military Retirement - Exempts an individual's military retirement benefits from state income tax up to \$65,000

SB 63 | Home School Rights - Allows home school students to use public school facilities to take their standardized tests (PSAT/SAT/ACT)

HB 307 | Improvements to Literacy - Guarantees alignment of all literacy curriculum with science of reading standards & early screening for dyslexia

HB 112 | Tax Rebate - Provides a tax rebate of up to \$500 per filer, returning \$1B to Georgia taxpayers



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About Scott

Scott Hilton is honored to represent House District 48, which includes the beautiful communities of **Johns Creek, Peachtree Corners, Alpharetta, and Roswell**. He and his wife, Meredith, live in Peachtree Corners, where they are raising their three children: Trent (18), Chase (16), and Caroline (13).

In the State House, Scott serves in several key leadership roles, including Chairman of the Information & Audits Committee and Secretary of the Education Committee. He also sits on four additional committees: Ways & Means, Public Health, Creative Arts & Entertainment, and MARTA Oversight.

Scott holds a bachelor's degree in finance from Georgetown University and an MBA from Emory University. He is also a proud graduate of Leadership Georgia. Scott and his wife Meredith, are small business owners, active community volunteers, and members of Perimeter Church in Johns Creek. In his free time, Scott enjoys hiking, playing pickleball, and announcing at his kids' sporting events.